4th The Fourth Sheet

Example report · SMEs

SAMPLE DATA · invented figures for demonstration

Which jobs actually make money?

Period: October 2026 to date. Every job's gross margin: revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time at $68 an hour (fully loaded: wages and all on-costs). Pick a type of job and every number, chart and note on the page follows it.

How final is this data?

October 2026 Incomplete October 2026 is still in progress: figures to 6 Oct only.

In short: Jobs made a 48.9% gross margin in October so far: maintenance contracts the most (63.9%), installations the least (30.4%).

Gross margin, not profit

Gross margin is not profit. Job gross margin = revenue less materials, subcontractors and technician time charged to the job at $68 an hour (wages and all on-costs). Not included: technician time not charged to any job (travel, training, waiting), and overheads (office wages, marketing, vehicles, rent, insurance, IT, depreciation, interest). Profit is what's left after those. Wages include their on-costs: super (12%) and leave as it's earned. No payroll tax: wages are under Queensland's $1.3 million threshold.

From gross margin to profit · latest closed month: September

October is still in progress and wages are paid fortnightly, so a part month can't be bridged: this is September, the latest closed month. September's jobs made $96,230 gross margin (42.7%). Technician time not charged to jobs took $28,417 and overheads $59,580, leaving $8,233 profit before tax (3.7% of revenue). To cover overheads, jobs need a 39.0% gross margin on average.

Gross margin on jobs	$96,230
Technician wages and on-costs	$79,587
Technician time charged to jobs (at cost)	$51,170
Technician time not charged to jobs	$28,417
Gross profit (the P&L)	$67,813
Overheads (operating expenses, depreciation, interest)	$59,580
Profit before tax (the P&L)	$8,233
Revenue	$225,460
Gross margin on jobs, %	42.7%
Profit before tax, % of revenue	3.7%
Gross margin jobs need just to cover overheads and time not charged	**39.0%**

Type of job: All jobs

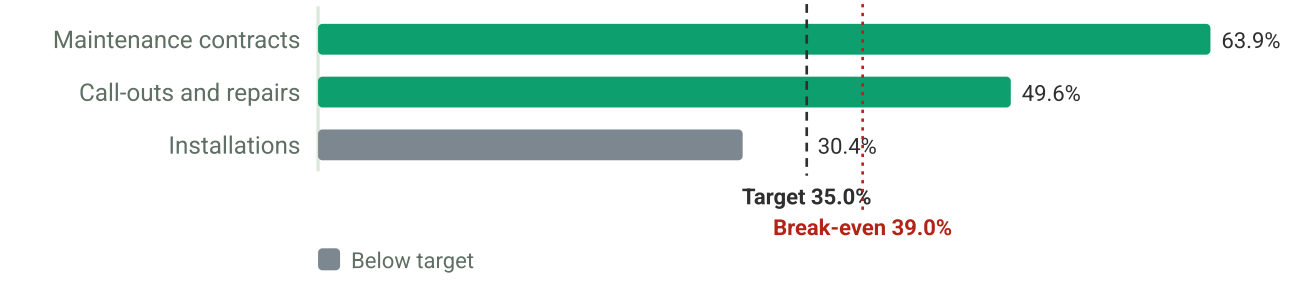
Job gross margin, October so far · All jobs
48.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · All jobs
42.7%
target 35.0%

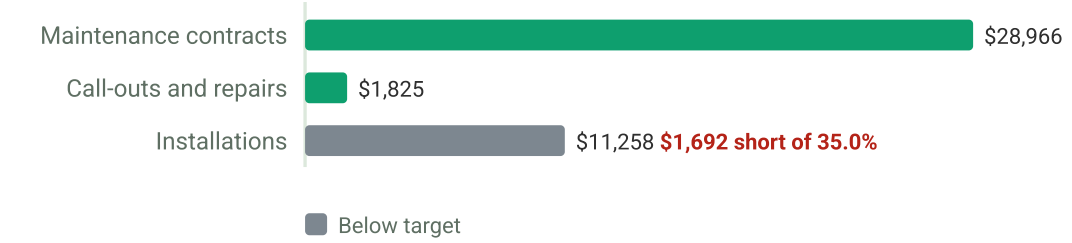
Gross margin jobs need to break even
39.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Job gross margin by type of job, October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

In October so far maintenance contracts made a 63.9% job gross margin, installations made a 30.4% job gross margin, call-outs and repairs made a 49.6% job gross margin (technician time at $68 an hour, wages and all on-costs). Jobs need 39.0% just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

Installations: 30.4% gross margin, 4.6 points under the 35.0% target: about $1,692 on $37,000 of revenue in October so far. It's below the 39.0% needed to cover overheads, too. Maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 in October so far).

Type of job: Maintenance contracts

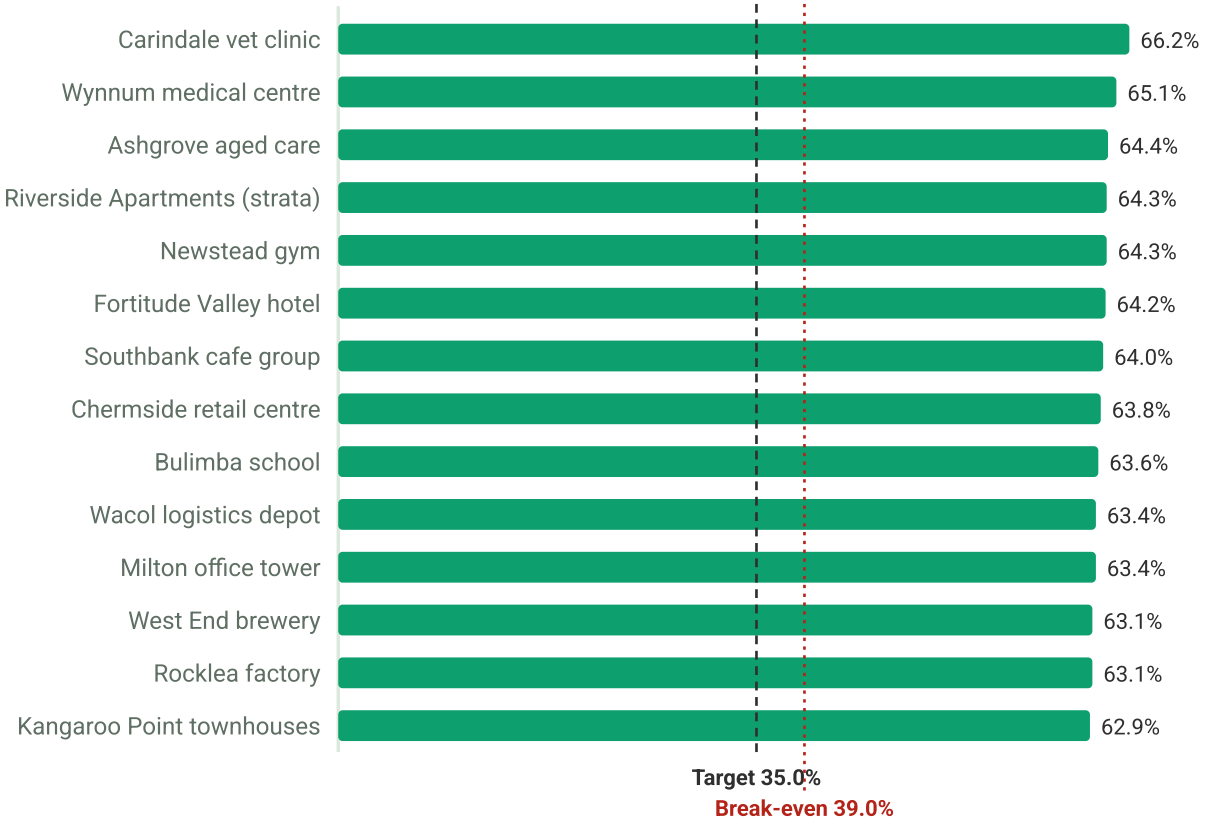
Job gross margin, October so far · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Maintenance contracts
63.9%
target 35.0%

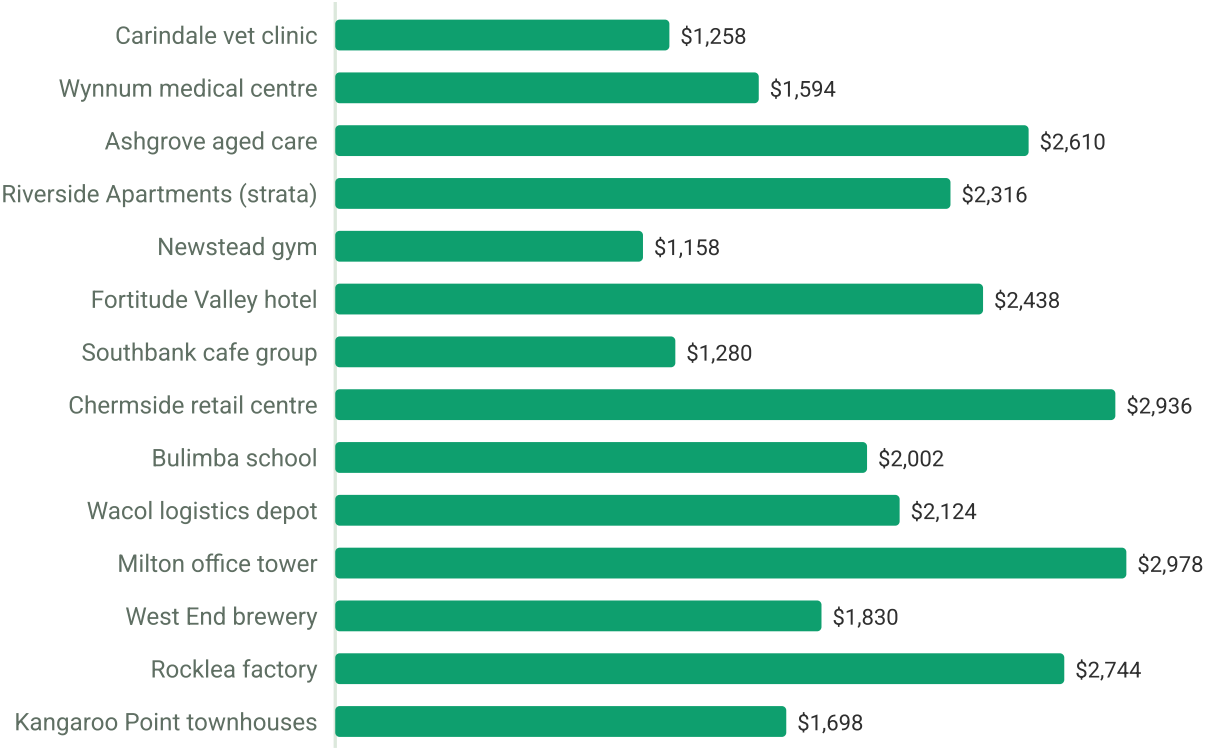
Gross margin jobs need to break even
39.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Job gross margin on each maintenance contract, October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

All 14 contracts made more than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The thinnest was Kangaroo Point townhouses at 62.9% job gross margin: 14.0 h of technician time on a $2,700 monthly fee.

What you'd do about it

The thinnest, Kangaroo Point townhouses: 62.9% gross margin, 27.9 points over the 35.0% target ($753 ahead on $2,700 in October so far). All maintenance contracts: 63.9% gross margin, 28.9 points over the 35.0% target ($13,094 ahead on $45,350 in October so far).

Type of job: Installations

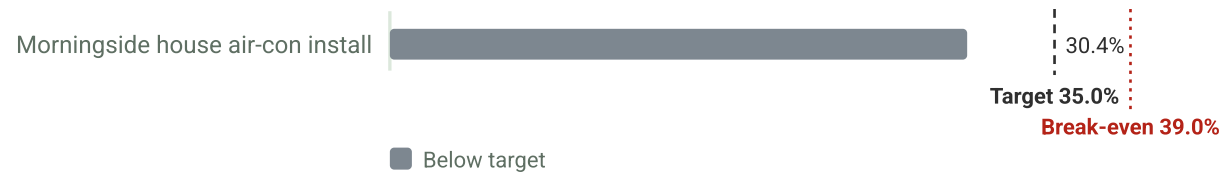
Job gross margin, October so far · Installations
30.4%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Installations
34.8%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
39.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Job gross margin on each installation invoiced in October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

1 of the 1 installation jobs invoiced in October so far made less than the 35.0% job gross margin target. The Morningside house air-con install made a 30.4% job gross margin: 131.5 h of technician time ($8,942) and $2,300 of subcontractors on a $37,000 job. Jobs need 39.0% gross margin just to cover overheads.

What you'd do about it

1 installation under the 35.0% target, worth about $1,692 between them on $37,000 of revenue. The biggest gap, Morningside house air-con install: 30.4% gross margin, 4.6 points under the 35.0% target: about $1,692 on $37,000 of revenue in October so far. It's below the 39.0% needed to cover overheads, too.

Type of job: Call-outs and repairs

Job gross margin, October so far · Call-outs and repairs
49.6%
target 35.0%

Job gross margin, September · Call-outs and repairs
48.3%
target 35.0%

Gross margin jobs need to break even
39.0%
covers overheads and time not charged (September)

Technician time charged, October so far
$2,771
75.3% of call-out revenue

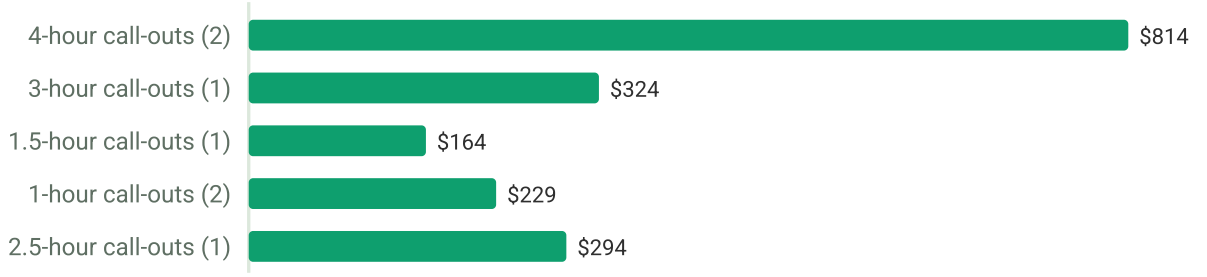
Materials charged, October so far
$910
$700 at cost, plus 30%

Job gross margin on call-outs by length, October 2026 to date

Gross margin %



Gross margin $



What it shows

7 call-outs in October so far billed $2,771 of technician time and $910 of materials ($700 at cost plus 30%), and made a 49.6% job gross margin between them. Gross margins run from 45.0% to 52.9% by length: the hourly rate covers technician time comfortably, so the gross margin mostly moves with how much material goes on the van.

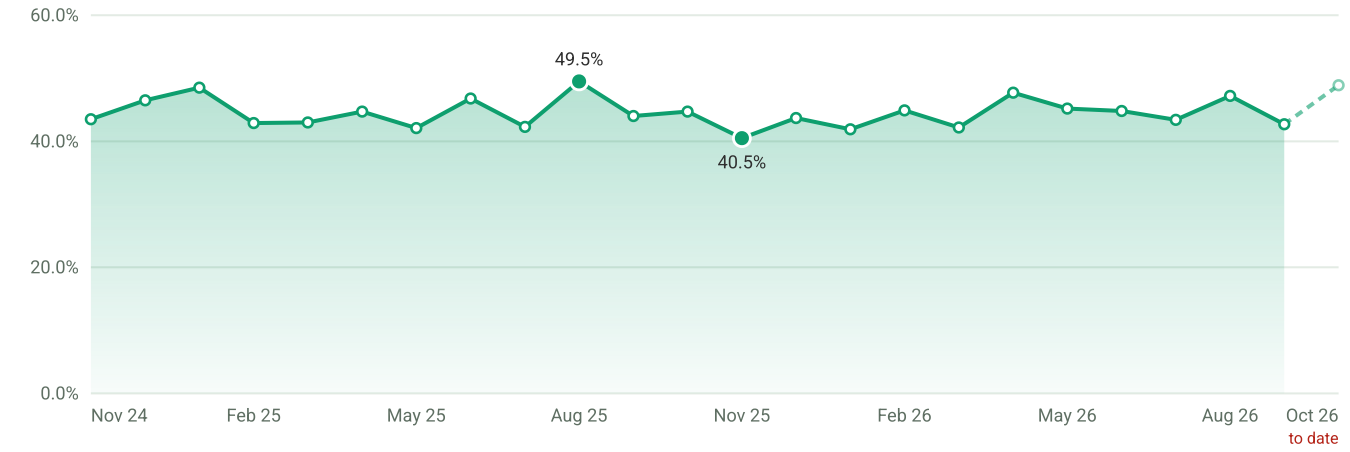
What you'd do about it

All call-outs: 49.6% gross margin, 14.6 points over the 35.0% target ($537 ahead on $3,681 in October so far).

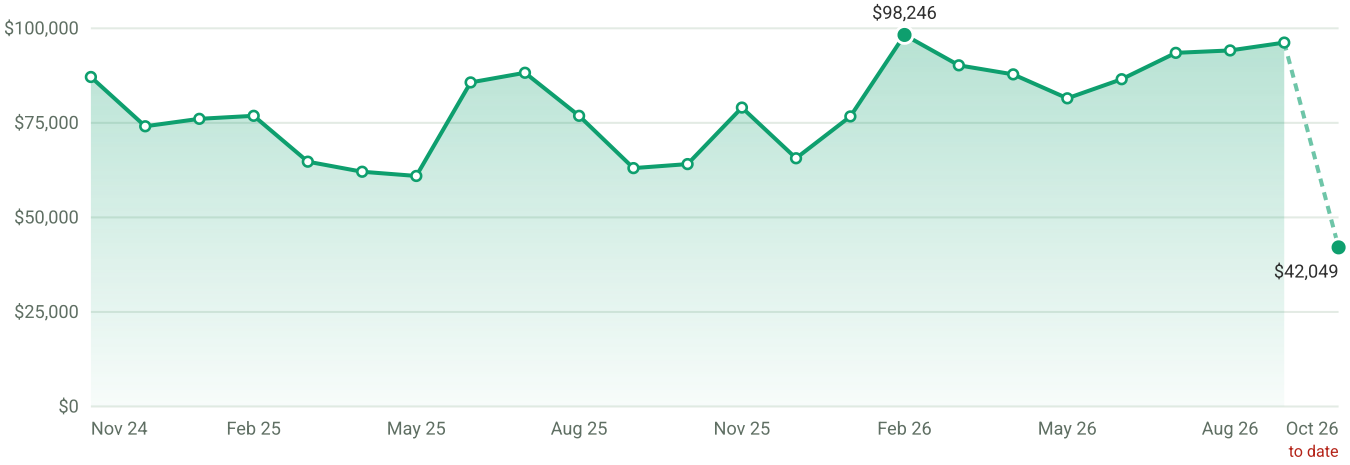
Every type of job at once

Job gross margin by month

All · Gross margin %



All · Gross margin $



Tap a month for its workings. Every month, by line, is in the spreadsheet download.

Made with Python: laid out in HTML and CSS, printed to PDF in Chromium.